

Marcus Webb

Principal Backend Engineer | Dublin, Ireland | marcus.webb@example.com | github.com/marcus-webb-example

Summary

Backend engineer with 11 years of experience building high-throughput payment and ledger systems in Java, Kotlin and Go. Led a team of six at a European fintech. Deep experience with event-driven architectures, Kubernetes and reliability engineering. Python is used mainly for scripting and tooling.

Experience

Principal Engineer, Payments Core, Halcyon Pay (Jan 2020 - Present), Dublin

Technical lead for the payments core team (6 engineers) that processes about 4 million card transactions per day.

- Designed an event-driven ledger on Kafka and PostgreSQL with exactly-once semantics for balance updates, supporting 2,500 transactions per second at peak.
- Led the move from a Java monolith to 14 Kotlin and Go services on Kubernetes, with zero customer-visible downtime.
- Cut p99 authorization latency from 480 ms to 140 ms by introducing request hedging and a read-through cache.
- Ran the reliability programme: SLOs for 9 services, game days twice a year and a 40% reduction in Sev-1 incidents.
- Hired and mentored six engineers; two were promoted to senior.
- Wrote internal Python tooling for load testing and data backfills (scripts, not services).

Senior Software Engineer, Brightline Bank (Apr 2016 - Dec 2019), London

- Built the card-dispute workflow in Java and Spring Boot, reducing manual handling time by 60%.
- Implemented PCI-DSS controls for tokenization services and supported two external audits.
- Introduced contract testing between 8 services using Pact.

Software Engineer, Meridian Systems (Jul 2013 - Mar 2016), Cork

- Developed back-office settlement software in Java and Oracle for retail banks.
- Career note: took a 4-month career break (Apr - Jul 2016 is not covered by a role) to relocate and study for the CKA.

Skills

Languages: Java (expert), Kotlin (expert), Go (advanced), SQL (advanced). Python: intermediate, scripting and tooling only.

Platform: Kubernetes (CKA certified), Docker, Terraform, Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, gRPC, OpenTelemetry, Grafana.

Domains: payments, ledgers, card processing, PCI-DSS, reliability engineering and incident management.

Education

MSc Computer Science, University College Cork (2011 - 2013). BSc Computer Science, University College Cork (2007 - 2011).

Certifications

Certified Kubernetes Administrator, CKA (issued Aug 2016, renewed Aug 2023, valid until Aug 2026).

Languages

English (native). German (basic).